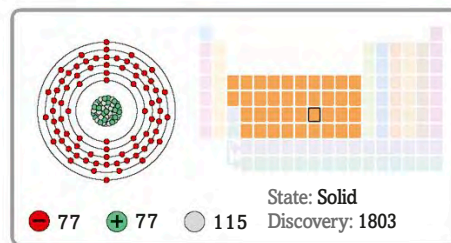


77
Ir

Iridium



Forms



Pure iridium crystals

This metal is 22 times as dense as water.



These rocks contain a layer of iridium-rich clay.

Badlands National Parks,
South Dakota, USA



Willamette meteorite

This meteorite, found in Oregon, USA, contains just 0.00047% iridium.

Iridium is the rarest natural element on Earth: there is one iridium atom out of every billion atoms in Earth's rocks. This dense metal can be found in its **pure** form in nature as well as in other common ores that contain nickel and copper. Iridium is present

in **meteorites** and other space rocks. A layer of iridium-rich clay is found in Earth's crust all over the world, especially in the **Badlands of South Dakota, USA**. Scientists believe this small quantity of iridium in our planet's crust was deposited by the dust from an